Community Water Quality Monitoring Procedure

technical_document | Municipal field technicians

Product	document_studio
Language	English
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CONTROLLED REVIEW ASSET. Human approval is required before external release.

Purpose: This procedure explains how field teams collect and record drinking water samples to ensure reliable results traceable to the correct site.

Scope: Applies to routine samples from reservoirs, treatment outlets, and public taps. Does not cover emergency chemical spills or laboratory instrument calibration.

Responsibilities: Team leader verifies each technician's PPE, clean sample bottles, and calibrated meter. Technicians are responsible for completing QMS-07's Chain of Custody Form and reporting unsafe conditions.

Procedure: Before sampling, allow the tap to run for 2 minutes. Rinse the probe with clean water but not sterile microbiological bottles. Record pH and turbidity in NTU at the site. Samples must be kept in a cooler between 2 and 8 degrees Celsius.

Data recording: Document site code, date, time, and sampler initials on both the bottle and QMS-07. Corrections must be made with a single line through the error; correction fluids are not permitted. State the reason for any missing reading.

Escalation: If pH is below 6.5 or above 9.5, or turbidity is more than 1 NTU, notify the team leader immediately. Do not declare the water safe or unsafe to the community until an authorised official has reviewed the results.